



MUSICIAN

JOB DESCRIPTION

For most musicians, music is not so much a career as a lifelong passion. To succeed, you need natural ability, dedication, and a lot of practice. Musicians may need formal training, especially in classical music or composition, but many are self-taught. Their earnings come from performing, recording, or writing music, either alone or as part of a group or an ensemble.



SALARY

Orchestral player ★★★★★
Successful music artist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Competitive industry • Mostly part-time and freelance work, although full-time roles in military bands and large orchestras available • Internet has changed the industry's business model

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Music • Entertainment • Songwriting and composition • Performance arts and culture



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree is not required, but you must be able to either sing or play an instrument, and to perform to a very high standard.



LIFESTYLE Rehearsals and recordings in a studio, or live performances during gigs and tours, can involve long hours. Schedules are highly irregular.



LOCATION Musicians may work in a recording studio, theater, school, or even a church. If touring, international travel may be required.



THE REALITIES This is a hugely competitive field. Performances can be tiring and stressful, whether live or in a studio.

CAREER PATHS

A musician's future depends partly on the genre of music chosen. If you play in an orchestra, your chances of becoming a soloist are low; if you play in a popular group, you could achieve huge, but often short-lived, commercial success.

AMATEUR Playing in a local band or orchestra and taking music classes will help you develop your skills, give you exposure to an audience, and may help you start a professional career in music.



GRADUATE If you study music at college, you will gain an understanding of theory, history, and technique. A music degree is not a guarantee of success as a performer, but it will give you access to other parts of the music business.

